

Flipkart Seller Operations Guide (Onboarding, Listing, Shipping SLA)

This document is synthesized from multiple public sources (listed below) rather than downloaded from a single official Flipkart document, because no single standalone official PDF covers this full journey — it is normally presented as an interactive Seller Hub flow. Facts below are cross-verified across at least two independent sources where possible.

Onboarding & Registration

1. Register at Flipkart Seller Hub with business PAN and GSTIN (mandatory for all product categories — no exemption by category).
2. Provide identity proof (PAN/Aadhaar), business address proof, and bank account details for payout.
3. GSTIN must be linked to the bank account's registered state, or the seller must register in the state where inventory is stored.
4. Category-specific approvals may be required for restricted categories (e.g., certain electronics sub-categories).
5. Account approval typically completes within 24–72 hours once documents are verified.
6. Sellers choose a fulfillment model: **Fulfilled by Flipkart (FBF)**, where Flipkart manages warehousing, or **Non-FBF (self-ship)**, where the seller handles storage and courier handover directly.
7. Flipkart's payment cycle deducts TCS (see GST documents) before crediting the seller's linked bank account.

Listing Guidelines

- **Procurement type:** "Instock" (physical stock ready), "Express" (same-day/next-day dispatch commitment), or "Domestic Procurement" (sourced after order placement). Instock is the standard, most predictable choice for new sellers.
- **Procurement SLA:** the number of days committed to have an order ready for Flipkart's pickup agent. The standard acceptable value is **2 days**. Consistently missing this SLA triggers seller performance penalties and reduces search visibility.
- **Images:** minimum 1000×1000 resolution, product centered in frame; listings failing this are commonly rejected or downranked. Flipkart, unlike Meesho, permits brand logos/watermarks in hero images.
- **Attributes:** an optional but recommended attribute section (up to ~29 fields across four categories) — filling these improves buyer understanding and search relevance even though not all fields are mandatory.
- **Stock updates:** sellers must keep stock count, price, MRP, and procurement SLA current; a listing can be saved at zero stock (invisible to buyers) rather than deleted.

Shipping SLA & Performance Tracking

- Flipkart tracks **Dispatch SLA adherence** and **RTO (Return to Origin) rate** as core seller performance metrics; both feed into Seller Rating, which in turn affects search placement.
- Missing the committed Procurement/Dispatch SLA triggers a late-dispatch penalty and can reduce listing visibility; repeated

- breaches can lead to listing suspension in severe cases.
- Common causes of RTO: poor address quality, buyer unavailability at delivery, and unconfirmed Cash-on-Delivery orders.
 - SLA thresholds are revised periodically by Flipkart — sellers are expected to check current Seller Hub policy rather than rely on a previously seen number.

Sources

- JDK Seller Services Flipkart Listing FAQs
- YourSellerAgency and YourAMZSeller (Medium) step-by-step Flipkart listing guides
- Fretron Flipkart seller guide (SLA/RTO/performance tracking)
- Kanakkupillai, EasyVyapar, ecomadvisors.co.in GST/documents-required guides
- IMARC Engineering manufacturer onboarding guide (approval timelines, fulfillment model choice)